AA-C-121b

SEPTEMBER 9, 1959

SUPERSEDING
Int. Fed. Spec. AA–C–00121a (GSA–FSS)
July 28, 1958 and
Fed. Spec. AA–C–121
February 2, 1932

FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

CASE, FILING, TRANSFER, STEEL

This specification was approved by the Commissioner, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, for the use of all Federal agencies.

1. SCOPE AND CLASSIFICATION

1.1 Scope.—This specification covers steel filing cases used in the transfer or storage of active or inactive records, documents, letters, file cards, etc.

1.2 Classification.

1.2.1 *Types and styles.*—The transfer cases covered in this specification shall be of the following types and styles, as specified:

Type I. — For tabulating cards; outside depth 24 inches; inside dimensions of drawer to be not less than 7½ inches wide by 22¾ inches deep by 3⅝ inches high. Two drawers to be used with each file case.

Type II.—For letter-size papers; outside depth 25 inches; inside dimensions of drawer to be not less than 12 inches wide by 22 inches deep by 10½ inches high.

Style A.—This style has roller bearings at the front of the case and roller bearings at the rear of the drawer.

Style B.—This style has an independent roller bearing tray which holds the drawer and traverses a formed channel attached to the inside of the transfer case.

Type III. — For cap-size papers; outside depth 25 inches, inside dimensions of drawer to be not less than 15¼ inches wide by 22 inches deep by 10½ inches high.

Style A.—This style has roller bearings at the front of the case and roller bearings at the rear of the drawer.

Style B.—This style has an independent roller bearing tray which holds the drawer and traverses a formed channel attached to the inside of the transfer case.

2. APPLICABLE SPECIFICATIONS AND STANDARDS

2.1 The following specifications and standards, of the issues in effect on date of invitation for bids, form a part of this specification:

Federal Specifications:

UU–P–270 — Paper, Wrapping, Waxed (Dry).

UU–T–111 — Tape; Paper, Gummed (Sealing and Securing).

PPP–B–591—Boxes, Fiberboard, Wood-Cleated.

PPP–B–601—Boxes, Wood, Cleated Plywood.

PPP–B–585—Boxes, Wood, Wirebound.

PPP–B–621—Boxes, Wood, Nailed and Lock-Corner.

PPP–B–636—Boxes, Fiber.

Federal Standards:

Fed. Std. No. 102—Preservation, Packaging and Packing Levels.

Fed. Std. No. 123—Marking for Domestic Shipment (Civilian Agencies).

521490/59/79

FSC 7125

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T11:39Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Fed. Std. No. 124 — Color of Painted Metal General Office Furniture.

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal Specifications and Standards as outlined under Government Information in the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards and at the prices indicated in the Index. The Index, which includes cumulative monthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U. S. Government Printing Office, Washington, D. C.

(Single copies of this specification and other product specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge at the General Services Administration Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, Mo., Dallas, Denver, San Francisco, Los Angeles, Seattle, and Washington, D. C.

(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal Specifications and Standards from established distribution points in their agencies.)

Military Specifications:

MIL–B–10377 — Box, Wood, Veneer, Paper Overlaid.

MIL–L–10547 — Liners, Case, Waterproof.

Military Standards:

MIL–STD–105 — Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.

MIL–STD–129—Marking for Shipment and Storage.

(Copies of Military Specifications and Standards required by the contractor in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Materials:

CHART 1
TYPE I Case
Sheet Metal Gages

Case body	24 Ga. (.0239″)
Case back	24 Ga. (.0239″)
Drawer body	24 Ga. (.0239″)
Drawer head	24 Ga. (.0239″)
Follower track	24 Ga. (.0239″)
Follower plate	24 Ga. (.0239″)

CHART 2
Style "A" Case
Types II and III
Sheet Metal Gages

Case body	22 Ga. (.0299″)
Case back	22 Ga. (.0299″)
Case track	14 Ga. (.0747″)
Drawer body	22 Ga. (.0299″)
Drawer head	22 Ga. (.0299″)
Drawer back	22 Ga. (.0299″)
Drawer inner head	22 Ga. (.0299″)
Drawer track	14 Ga. (.0747″)
Intermembering clip	14 Ga. (.0747″)
Follower plate	18 Ga. (.0478″)
Follower track	22 Ga. (.0299″)
Follower saddle	12 Ga. (.1046″)
Base	18 Ga. (.0478″)
Base angle	18 Ga. (.0478″)
Drawer handle	18 Ga. (.0478″)
Label holder	22 Ga. (.0299″)

CHART 3
Bar Stock

Drawer stop	⅛″ × 1″
Follower handle	¼″ Dia.
Case reinforcing	3/16″ × 1″

CHART 4
Style "B" Case
Type II and III
Sheet Metal Gages

Case slide	16 Ga. (.0598″)
Drawer head	20 Ga. (.0359″)
Drawer inner head	20 Ga. (.0359″)
Drawer head inner plate	18 Ga. (.0478″)
Drawer head reinforcement	20 Ga. (.0359″)
Drawer bumper holder	22 Ga. (.0299″)
Extension slide	14 Ga. (.0747″)
Slide spreader (front and center)	14 Ga. (.0747″)
Slide spreader (rear)	14 Ga. (.0747″)
Extension slide stop	20 Ga. (.0359″)
Bumper stop	11 Ga. (.1196″)
Latch	16 Ga. (.0598″)
Latch arm	20 Ga. (.0359″)

Bar stock

Roller support ⅛″ × ½″

Note.—All parts of the style B case that are common or similar in function to the style A are the same gage or stock size as that required in Charts 2 and 3.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T11:39Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

3.1.1 *Face hardware.*—The face hardware for cases, except type I and style A cases, shall be satin-finished anodized aluminum or type 430 corrosion-esistant steel or brushed chromium on steel or on die-cast zinc, brass or bronze. The face hardware for style A cases shall have the drawer pulls and label holders formed of sheet metal and painted to match the case.

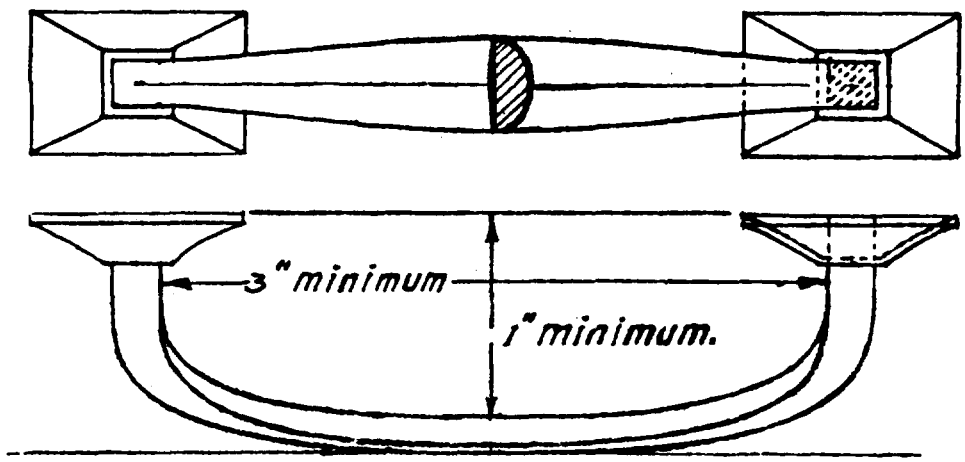
3.1.2 *Drawer pulls.* — The drawer pulls shall be of the materials specified in 3.1.1. The pulls shall be similar to the design shown in figure 1, except type I and style A cases, with all surfaces and edges ground smooth to eliminate roughness and sharp edges. Pulls shall be securely attached with screws or nuts and lockwashers which shall be surface mounted if attached to the inside of the drawer head or countersunk if mounted to the double wall of the drawer front. Handhole shall be not less than the minimum dimensions shown in figure 1.

3.1.3 *Label holders.* — The label holders shall be of the material specified in 3.1.1. For style B cases the label holders shall be secured to the drawer front by not less than two screws or by nuts and lockwashers. For type I and style A cases the label holder shall be secured to the drawer front by tabs on the label holder which pass through the drawer front and are then bent or twisted. The label holder shall readily accommodate, without binding, not less than $2\frac{15}{16}$-inch by $1\frac{3}{4}$-inch label cards.

3.1.4 *Drawer latch.*—Each drawer for style B cases only shall have a readily controlled automatic drawer latch sufficiently strong to hold the loaded drawer in a closed position against a normal rebound, a tilt, or an uneven floor. The latching mechanism shall be guarded or concealed, eliminating hazard of torn clothing or scratched hands. The latch release button shall be of the material specified in 3.1.1 and shall be conveniently located near the drawer pull.

3.2 Construction.

3.2.1 *Case body—type I.*—The case body shall have a closed top, bottom, sides and back. The back is to be enclosed by means of a $\frac{5}{16}$-inch flange, securely welded to the inside of the case. The inside front of the case shall be provided with a $\frac{1}{8}$-inch by 1-inch milled edge reinforcement securely welded to the case. This reinforcement is to be provided with two imbedded centered, nylon bearings, or equal material, so placed that they contact the bottom of the file drawer. Case bodies shall be interlocked when stacking them into a multiple rack of files. This may be done by



Drawer Pull

FIGURE 1.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T11:39Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

tabs interlocking with the adjacent case or by nut and bolt fastening. Construction of files shall be of sufficient strength to permit stacking of transfer cases to a height of 12 feet without danger of falling, and also designed to permit easy erection or disassembly.

3.2.2 *Case body—types II and III, style A.*—The case body shall be constructed of sheet steel, having a closed top, sides and back. The front edge of the case body shall be reinforced on the inside with $\frac{3}{16}$-inch by 1-inch steel bar. The back of the case shall be enclosed with sheet steel welded to the sides of the case body. The inside surface of the case body shall have a formed channel welded thereto, providing a track for the roller bearing of the drawer to traverse. Two drawer stops shall be welded to the bottom of the case on the inside front. Case bodies shall be provided with a suitable means of interlocking the cases front and back when stacking them into a multiple unit. This may be done by interlocking tabs or nut and bolt fastening. Matching holes shall be provided in the side of the case near the front upper corner so adjacent stacks may be bolted together. Roller bearings shall be attached to the reinforcing frame on both sides of the case to provide easy opening and closing of the drawer.

3.2.3 *Case body—types II and III, style B.*—The construction of this style of case body is the same as that specified in paragraph 3.2.2 with the following exceptions. Roller bearings are not required on the inside front of the case body. Larger formed metal channels shall be welded to the inside surface of the case body, providing a track for the roller tray assembly to traverse.

3.2.4 *Drawer, type I.*—Drawer bottom and sides shall be made of one piece and designed to include an open-type serrated channel to accommodate a positive type card compressing follower plate. Each drawer shall have a free depth of 22¾ inches for filing tabulating cards, when the follower is in a rear-most position. The follower shall easily be operated with one hand for easy removal of tabulating cards. Drawers are to be equipped with a drawer stop that shall withstand an ultimate pull of 250 pounds. The drawer front shall have one drawer pull and label holder securely fastened thereto.

3.2.5 *Drawer, types II and III, style A.*—The drawer body shall be one piece of sheet steel, forming a bottom and two sides. The bottom shall be channeled for recessing the follower plate track and the top of the sides box shaped for rigidity and safety. The drawer header shall be welded to the bottom and sides of the drawer. All exposed edges shall be rounded by reverse bending and forming flanges on the inside or outside. The drawer back shall be one piece and spot welded to the drawer body. The drawer front shall have an inner head shaped for stabilizing drawer front and forming a recess for receiving the drawer pull fastening hardware. A formed steel follower track shall be permanently attached to the center of the bottom of the drawer. The two top turned in flanges shall be punched on 1-inch centers to receive the follower plate locking bar. Each drawer shall have a drawer pull and label holder securely fastened to the drawer head. The sides of the drawer shall have an angle formed track for supporting drawer as they are pulled or pushed over roller bearings that are fastened to the case body. Two rollers shall be attached to rear of drawer track angle for ease of operation of drawer. The rear of the drawer shall have a drawer stop formed as an integral part of the drawer-track support. The drawer back shall have an opening placed near the top and of sufficient size to permit gripping for lifting the drawer. The top edge of cut out shall be flanged to prevent injury of one's hand when lifting the drawers when heavily loaded. Drawer when extended shall be horizontal with case body.

3.2.6 *Drawer—types II and III, style B.*—This style of drawer shall be constructed substantially the same as that specified in paragraph 3.2.5 with the following deletions and additions. The top of drawer head shall be reinforced with sheet steel in the area of the label-holder mounting. This will provide a

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T11:39Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

greater rounded edge and reinforcement to top of drawer, thus strengthening the label-holder mounting. The drawer head shall have a drawer latch mechanism enclosed within the drawer inner head, controlled by a thumb knob placed at the left side of the drawer pull. This shall be so designed that the drawer is locked into a closed position when fully closed. The latch keeper shall be attached to the side of the case body. The drawer head shall have two drawer inner heads formed into mating channels to conceal latch mechanism and reinforce head. The one facing the inside of drawer shall be sufficiently recessed at the drawer-pull mounting as to prevent the nuts and bolts from extending beyond the inside surface of the drawer inner head. This drawer shall have no roller bearings attached thereto. Both sides of drawers shall have an angle runner or track attached to form a bearing surface for rolling over the roller bearings of the progressive extension roller tray.

3.2.7 *Progressive extension roller tray, types II and III, style B.*—This tray shall have two angles forming sides for the tray. The angles shall be tapered toward the front of the tray. Each tray shall have three spreaders; one front, one center and one at the rear. The side angles shall have three roller bearings which roll on the bottom of the case slide or track. The angles shall have two roller bearings mounted on the top for supporting tray in case track when extending the drawer. The tray shall be equipped with stops with rubber bumpers attached or against which the rubber bumpers of the drawer stop to prevent noise when the tray is fully extended. The tray shall also be equipped with two rubbers to contact the case back to prevent noise when the drawer is fully closed.

3.2.8 *Follower plate.* — All size drawers shall be equipped with a follower plate assembly for holding the filed material in an upright position. The top of the plate shall be box shaped for rigidizing and eliminating any sharp edges. The top of the plate shall have a cut out sufficiently large to operate the locking bar. The follower shall have a saddle welded thereto for sliding in the flanged channel of the drawer bottom. The follower handle shall be ¼-inch-diameter rod formed into a "U" shape. The handle shall have two helical expansion springs for holding the pointed ends of the handle in the holes of the channel flange resulting in positive engagement. The saddle of the follower shall be free sliding in the drawer channel.

3.2.9 *Base platform.*—When specified, base platforms shall be supplied for the type and style of cases listed in paragraph 1.2.1. The base shall be 3 inches high and 25 inches deep. The base shall be sufficiently flanged top and bottom as to prevent undue marring of floors and to provide adequate material for bolting to bottom of transfer case. Bases shall have matching bolt holes at front and intermembering clip at rear.

3.3 Finish.—All metal surfaces shall be subjected to cleaning and shall be thoroughly dried before they are treated further. The finish coat shall be standard gray in accordance with Federal Standard No. 124.

3.4 Intermembering.—All sections shall intermember with and match in size the standard sections adopted by the Federal Supply Service.

3.5 Workmanship.—All exposed edges of steel sheets shall be rounded or smoothed as to avoid sharp-cutting edges. All construction shall be of good workmanship.

4. SAMPLING, INSPECTION, AND TEST PROCEDURES

4.1 Supplier's responsibility. — Unless otherwise specified herein, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements prior to submission for Government inspection and acceptance. Except as otherwise specified, the supplier may utilize his own facilities or a commercial laboratory acceptable to the Government. Inspection records of the examinations and tests shall be kept complete and available to the Government as specified in the contract or order.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T11:39Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

4.2 **Lot.**—A lot shall consist of all filing cases of the same type and style offered for delivery at one time.

4.3 **Sampling.**—Sampling for examination shall be conducted in accordance with Military Standard MIL–STD–105.

4.4 **Examination.**—Samples of filing cases shall be examined in accordance with the provisions of Military Standard MIL–STD–105 to determine conformance with the requirements of this specification.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

For civil agency procurement Federal Standard No. 102 shall be referred to for definitions and applications of the various levels of packaging protection for supplies and equipment.

5.1 **Packaging.**—Packaging shall be level A or C as specified (see 6.1).

5.1.1 *Level A.*—All drawers shall be closed and the exposed finished surface of each case protected from abrasion by wrapping or covering with waxed paper conforming to Federal Specification UU–P–270. All finished surfaces and projecting parts shall be further protected with cushioning material, minimum one-fourth of an inch thick, fabricated in the form of pads or blankets made of the following materials or a combination thereto:

Macerated paper, plain	Excelsior (sealed ends)
Macerated paper, tissue-faced	Cotton wadding
Shredded paper	Moulded pulpboard
Wood wool	Laminated cellulose
Wood fiber felt	Wadding backed with corrugated fiberboard
Cellulose wadding	

When macerated paper, tissue-faced, cellulose wadding, cotton wadding, or laminated cellulose wadding backed with corrugated fiberboard are used, the initial sheet of waxed paper will not be required. Cushioning shall be so applied as to prevent marring, puncturing, or abrading of any finished surfaces. Cushioning shall be secured in place with tape conforming to class 2 of Federal Specification UU–T–111 or jute, sisal, Manila, or cotton twine, having a minimum breaking strength of 30 pounds, in such a manner as to prevent any possibility of shifting or becoming detached during transit or storage.

5.1.2 *Level C.*—The cases shall be packaged in accordance with the manufacturer's commercial practice.

5.2 **Packing.**—Packing shall be level A, B or C as specified (see 6.1).

5.2.1 *Level A.* — Each case, packaged as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a snug-fitting fiberboard shipping container conforming to class 2, V3c or V3s, style RSC of Federal Specification PPP–B–636. Alternatively, shipping containers conforming to overseas type of Federal Specification PPP–B–591 or PPP–B–601; class 2, style 2 or 4 of Federal Specification PPP–B–585, PPP–B–621 or Military Specification MIL–B–10377 may be used. Each shipping container shall be provided with a type I or II, grade B or C, class 2 sealed case liner conforming to Military Specification MIL–L–10547. Each shipping container shall be closed and strapped in accordance with the appendix of the applicable container specification.

5.2.2 *Level B.* — Each case, packaged as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a snug-fitting fiberboard shipping container conforming to type I or II, class 1, style RSC of Federal Specification PPP–B–636, except that the minimum bursting strength of the fiberboard shall be 275 p.s.i. All flaps of the fiberboard shipping containers shall be securely sealed with an adhesive commercially used for the specific product being packed by application throughout the entire area of contact between the flaps, or by a combination of metal stitching the bottom flaps and sealing the top flaps with adhesive. Alternatively, shipping containers conforming to domestic type, style A or B of Federal Specification PPP–B–591 or PPP–B–601; class 1, style 2 or 4 of Federal Specification PPP–B–621; or style 1, 2 or 2A, class 1 use, type 2 load of Federal Specification PPP–B–585 may be used.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T11:39Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

5.2.3 *Level C.*—The cases, packaged as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a manner to insure carrier acceptance and safe delivery at destination. Containers shall be in accordance with Uniform Freight Classification Rules or regulations of other carriers applicable to the mode of transportation.

5.3 Marking.

5.3.1 *Nonmilitary.* — In addition to any special marking required by the contract or order, shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with the requirements of Federal Standard No. 123.

5.3.2 *Military requirements.*—In addition to any special marking required by the contract or order, shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with the requirements of Military Standard MIL–STD–129.

6. NOTES

6.1 Ordering data.—Purchasers should exercise any desired options offered herein, and procurement documents should specify type and style required and should specify the following:

(*a*) Selection of applicable levels of packaging and packing, and marking (see 5.1 and 5.2, and 5.3).

(*b*) Whether only one type, style, and size shipping container should be used for any one item on any one contract (see 5.2.1 and 5.2.2).

(*c*) Number of bases needed (see 3.2.9) and for what type and style of case. Quantity of bases depends upon number of stacks desired. Procurement document should also state that levels of packaging and packing for bases should be the same as for the cases.

6.2 Military Standards.—Items procured under this specification for military use are to be limited to the variety shown on the applicable military standards. Personnel of the military departments are requested to refer to these documents for guidance.

6.3 Transportation Description.—Transportation description and minimum weight applicable to this commodity are:

Rail:

Filing cases, not otherwise indexed by name, steel. (Specify set-up or knocked-down)

Carload minimum weights:

In cars 40'9" or less in length, inside measurements — 10,000; 12,000; 15,000; 18,000; 22,000 and 30,000 pounds.

In cars 40'9" in length, inside measurements—16,000; 18,000; 21,000; 24,000; 30,000 and 40,000 pounds.

Motor:

Filing cases, not otherwise indexed, steel, (Specify set-up or knocked-down)

Truckload minimum weight — 10,000; 12,000; 15,000; 18,000; 22,000 and 30,000 pounds, subject to Rule 34, National Motor Freight Classification.

Notice. — When Government drawings, specifications, or other data are used for any purpose other than in connection with a definitely related Government procurement operation, the United States Government thereby incurs no responsibility nor any obligation whatsoever; and the fact that the Government may have formulated, furnished, or in any way supplied the said drawings, specifications, or other data, is not to be regarded, by implication or otherwise as in any manner licensing the holder or any other person or corporation, or conveying any rights or permission to manufacture, use, or sell any patented invention that may in any way be related thereto.

MILITARY INTERESTS:
Army—Q
Air Force.

Copies of this specification may be purchased for 5 cents each.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T11:39Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.